

# Vesna Nightingale

## Character Dossier

*Playful, with a cruel streak they regret tattooist of Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn*

## Overview

Vesna Nightingale is a tattooist living in Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn. Vesna is 59 years old, originally from Two Rivers, and is known around Ring Deck 4 as playful, with a cruel streak they regret. In conversation Vesna hums a few notes between thoughts.

## Background

Vesna arrived in Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn 6 years ago after leaving Two Rivers under circumstances Vesna describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Oryn Extraction Consortium; the second was the one that stuck. Today Vesna works as a tattooist near the hydroponics bay and is paid, when paid at all, in station credits.

Vesna learned the trade from Orsolya Merriwether, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Vesna's life is with Isadora Grimsby, over a matter neither will explain. The person Vesna trusts most is Kenji Marchetti.

Current goal: to prove Isadora Grimsby wrong about the old tunnels. Greatest fear: a knock at the door after dark.

## Personality and speech

Temperament: playful, with a cruel streak they regret.

Speech pattern: Vesna hums a few notes between thoughts.

Tells: when lying, Vesna mentions Quibble the tortoise for no reason.

## Verified facts

*These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.*

|                |                                                              |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Full name      | Vesna Nightingale                                            |
| Role           | tattooist                                                    |
| Home           | Kepler Station, a mining outpost orbiting the gas giant Oryn |
| Hometown       | Two Rivers                                                   |
| Age            | 59                                                           |
| Favourite dish | grandmother's sour cherry soup                               |
| Pet            | Quibble, a tortoise                                          |

|                          |                     |
|--------------------------|---------------------|
| <i>Lucky number</i>      | 716                 |
| <i>Workshop password</i> | oak-orchid          |
| <i>Mentor</i>            | Orsolya Merriwether |
| <i>Rival</i>             | Isadora Grimsby     |
| <i>Closest friend</i>    | Kenji Marchetti     |

## Secret

Vesna was the one who let the animals loose during the festival three years ago.

## Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Vesna: I am the tattooist. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Vesna: Grandmother's sour cherry soup. Do not tell Isadora I said so.

Visitor: Is Quibble yours?

Vesna: Quibble belongs to nobody. Quibble tolerates me. Lucky number is 716, if you were about to ask.

## Chronicle

*Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.*

### **Entry 1, spring of year 10**

Vesna was hired to carry a clockwork bird from Ring Deck 4 to the ore refinery without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached Ring Deck 4. Vesna pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Someone left a coil of rope on the doorstep with no note. Vesna suspects Kenji and is probably right. The weather turned. Vesna moved the sack of salt indoors, fed Quibble, and wrote three lines to Orsolya about the new curfew.

### **Entry 2, winter of year 10**

Vesna found a spool of wire half-buried near the observation lounge and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Vesna and Isadora outside the observation lounge; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the observation lounge. Vesna pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A stranger asked Vesna for the password to the workshop. Vesna laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

### **Entry 3, summer of year 10**

A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Vesna and Isadora outside the hydroponics bay; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Vesna closed early, walked to Dockmaster's Row, and watched the lights come on. Quibble followed at a distance. A stranger asked Vesna for the password to the workshop. Vesna laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Someone left a copper pipe on the doorstep with no note. Vesna suspects Kenji and is probably right. Xiomara came by asking about the census. Vesna said nothing useful and made tea instead.

### **Entry 4, spring of year 10**

Someone left a bolt of linen on the doorstep with no note. Vesna suspects Kenji and is probably right. Someone left a sack of salt on the doorstep with no note. Vesna suspects Kenji and is probably right. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the ore refinery. Vesna pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Vesna closed early, walked to Dockmaster's Row, and watched the lights come on. Quibble followed at a distance.

### **Entry 5, spring of year 10**

Vesna won 44 station credits from Isadora on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on grandmother's sour cherry soup. The weather turned. Vesna moved the sextant indoors, fed Quibble, and wrote three lines to Orsolya about the rumour of a second well. Someone left a bundle of letters on the doorstep with no note. Vesna suspects Kenji and is probably right. A stranger asked Vesna for the password to the workshop. Vesna laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Vesna closed early, walked to the observation lounge, and watched the lights come on. Quibble followed at a distance.

### **Entry 6, autumn of year 10**

Vesna spent the day counting stock at the ore refinery: 52 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short. Vesna won 11 station credits from Isadora on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on grandmother's sour cherry soup. the Oryn Extraction Consortium sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Vesna read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

#### ***Entry 7, spring of year 10***

At Ring Deck 4, Vesna taught Kenji how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone. Someone left a cracked compass on the doorstep with no note. Vesna suspects Kenji and is probably right. Vesna was hired to carry a clockwork bird from Ring Deck 4 to the observation lounge without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

#### ***Entry 8, winter of year 10***

Vesna repaired the copper pipe at Ring Deck 4 for Dorothea, who paid in 59 station credits and a long story about the old tunnels. Vesna found a signal flag half-buried near Ring Deck 4 and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Vesna won 50 station credits from Isadora on a bet about the tax on doors and spent all of it on grandmother's sour cherry soup.

#### ***Entry 9, spring of year 11***

At the ore refinery, Vesna taught Kenji how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone. the Oryn Extraction Consortium sent a notice about the rumour of a second well. Vesna read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Vesna repaired the copper pipe at the ore refinery for Lysander, who paid in 87 station credits and a long story about the census.

#### ***Entry 10, autumn of year 11***

Vesna repaired the clockwork bird at the hydroponics bay for Kenji, who paid in 85 station credits and a long story about the harvest count. the Oryn Extraction Consortium sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Vesna read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Vesna won 88 station credits from Isadora on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on grandmother's sour cherry soup. Vesna spent the day counting stock at the hydroponics bay: 84 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short.

#### ***Entry 11, spring of year 11***

the Oryn Extraction Consortium sent a notice about the missing shipment. Vesna read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Vesna spent the day counting stock at the hydroponics bay: 88 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. Orsolya visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before.